

AMENDMENT 3: WHAT IT DOES TO YOUR TAX BILL

Eleven Sarasota County communities, measured parcel by parcel. On the ballot 3 November 2026. Updated 13 September 2026.

Start here: an exemption is not money off your bill

It is a slice of your home's assessed value that does not get taxed. A \$250,000 exemption does not mean \$250,000 off what you pay. It means \$250,000 of your assessed value is set aside, and you are taxed on what is left.

So what it saves you depends on your millage rate, which is why the same exemption is worth different amounts in different communities. Non-school millage is 5.3787 in unincorporated Sarasota County and 8.4154 in the City of North Port. Gran Paradiso, IslandWalk, Renaissance, Sunstone and Brightmore are in the City of North Port for tax purposes, despite having Venice mailing addresses.

The exemption amounts

Today	\$51,411 of assessed value. \$25,000 of that comes off every tax including school; the other \$26,411 comes off non-school taxes only.
1 Jan 2027	\$150,000 comes off non-school taxes. The \$25,000 against school taxes stays exactly as it is.
1 Jan 2028	\$250,000 comes off non-school taxes.
2029 on	Adjusted for inflation each year.
Separately	The cap on how fast a non-homestead assessed value can rise drops from 10% a year to 5%. Second homes, rentals, commercial. No exemption involved.

It needs 60% of the vote to pass, not a simple majority. If it passes, it first shows up on the August 2027 TRIM notice and the tax bill mailed in November 2027.

What that looks like on a real bill

A homesteaded home assessed at \$350,000. Annual ad valorem taxes.

	Unincorporated Sarasota	City of North Port
Assessed value	\$350,000	\$350,000
Taxed on today, non-school	\$298,589	\$298,589
Non-school tax today	\$1,606	\$2,513
Taxed on in 2028, non-school	\$100,000	\$100,000
Non-school tax in 2028	\$538	\$842
Saving on that line	\$1,068 a year	\$1,671 a year
School tax, unchanged	\$1,981 a year	\$1,981 a year
Ad valorem total, today	\$3,587	\$4,494
Ad valorem total, 2028	\$2,519	\$2,822

Neither column includes CDD, fire, solid waste or stormwater. Those are non-ad valorem assessments. They are on the same bill and the exemption does not touch them.

How many homes here would actually owe nothing

Every homesteaded parcel in eleven communities, modelled at the full \$250,000 exemption in 2028. The figure repeated statewide is roughly 60%. It is not 60% anywhere here.

Community	Homesteads	Median assessed	Owe zero non-school tax in 2028
Gulf Gate Woods	84	\$262,704	37 homes, 44%
Gran Paradiso	1,212	\$340,759	365 homes, 30%
Renaissance	487	\$347,600	110 homes, 23%
Palmero	127	\$404,987	24 homes, 19%
Grand Palm	718	\$350,809	132 homes, 18%
Brightmore	103	\$363,400	19 homes, 18%
IslandWalk	1,764	\$351,791	257 homes, 15%
Sunstone	144	\$325,100	21 homes, 15%
Talon Preserve	351	\$526,100	27 homes, 8%
Sarasota National	936	\$384,914	66 homes, 7%
Sunrise Preserve	282	\$495,622	17 homes, 6%

A home reaches zero when the \$250,000 exemption covers its whole assessed value. For most homes that means assessed at or below \$250,000, but a senior, veteran, widow or disability exemption stacks on top of the \$250,000 and lifts that threshold. Checked against real Gran Paradiso addresses on the live calculator: \$249,400 returns zero, \$292,600 returns \$358, \$315,900 returns \$555.

Why the spread: the exemption is a fixed dollar amount, not a percentage. \$250,000 removes a \$246,600 assessment entirely and leaves \$38,600 of a \$288,600 one. Higher assessed values mean fewer homes reach zero.

The part of your bill that does not change, with real numbers

One verified 2026 TRIM notice per community, near that community's median assessed value. These are single parcels, not averages.

Gran Paradiso \$2,721	West Villages ID \$1,949.16, North Port fire rescue \$362.52, solid waste \$332.75, roads and drainage \$30.93 and \$46.00. Parcel assessed \$340,774.
Sarasota National \$2,311	Sarasota National CDD \$1,496.99, fire rescue \$366.80, solid waste \$263.96, stormwater \$183.63. Parcel assessed \$401,166.
IslandWalk \$1,412	West Villages ID \$562.78, North Port fire rescue \$485.73, solid waste \$332.75, roads and drainage \$30.93. Parcel assessed \$340,699.
Palmero \$859	No CDD. Fire rescue \$469.76, solid waste \$263.96, stormwater \$125.10. Parcel assessed \$404,987.
Gulf Gate Woods \$768	No CDD. Fire rescue \$315.70, solid waste \$263.96, stormwater \$187.88. Parcel assessed \$263,852.
Talon Preserve \$717	No CDD. Fire rescue \$314.67, solid waste \$263.96, stormwater \$138.01. Parcel assessed \$468,400.

Gran Paradiso and IslandWalk are in the same West Villages district and their district lines are more than three times apart, because the bond series differ by phase. Talon Preserve, Palmero and Gulf Gate Woods have no CDD at all. Your own figure is on your own TRIM notice and nowhere else.

The deadline most people have not heard about

If you are a permanent Florida resident by 31 December 2026, you get the full exemption from the start. If you establish Florida residency on or after 1 January 2027, you start at \$50,000 and become eligible for the full amount in your fifth year. That is four years of waiting, not one.

It turns on residency, not on buying. You can become a Florida resident in December and buy a house in March.

One caution. The judge who ordered the ballot summary rewritten in August found the state's own wording wrong on this point, ruling it also depends on when you first claim a homestead exemption. If this affects you, call the Sarasota County Property Appraiser on 941-861-8200 before you do anything. It is free and theirs is the answer that counts.

Four things people are getting wrong

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| 1 | That property taxes are being eliminated. They are not. School taxes stay, and so does everything below the exemption amount. |
| 2 | That the CDD goes away. It does not. On a Gran Paradiso bill the CDD line is bigger than the saving. |
| 3 | That the previous owner's exemption transfers with the house. It does not. Every new owner files their own. |
| 4 | That missing 1 January costs you one year. If you are already a Florida resident, yes. If you are moving here from out of state, it is four years. |

There is a second side to this, and it is fair to say so

The amendment does not guarantee any level of service funding. A judge ordered the ballot summary rewritten in August partly for implying that it did. It does restrict spending: counties and municipalities would have to use property tax revenue solely for public safety, education and schools, infrastructure, natural resources, bond debt service and retirement benefits. That is a limit on what the money can be spent on, not a promise of how much there will be.

The state's own estimate of the revenue reduction is \$4.95 billion in fiscal year 2027-28, \$8.78 billion the following year and \$11.86 billion the year after. Revenue Estimating Conference, House final bill analysis. What any local government does about that is a budget decision nobody has made yet.

See your own address, line by line, free and with no signup:

floridahomevalueai.com/property-tax-calculator

Community figures modelled from the Sarasota County certified tax roll, 10,154 parcels, using the county's published 2025 millage by tax district. Verified against 2026 TRIM notices and against the live calculator. This is arithmetic on public records. It is not tax advice, not legal advice and not an appraisal, and it assumes the amendment passes as written. For anything about your own situation, the Sarasota County Property Appraiser on 941-861-8200 is the right call. This page takes no position on how anyone should vote.

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